

MARKET PULSE · MID-WEEK TRADING REPORT

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Wednesday 20 May 2026

OUTLOOK · NEUTRAL-BULLISH

MACRO THEME

Moody's strips US Aaa to Aa1; NVDA Q1 FY2027 record \$81.6B revenue +85% YoY; US30 new year high 50,830; UK CPI 2.8% soft; gold correction extends below 4,550.

OVERVIEW

Moody's stripped the US of its final Aaa sovereign rating (downgraded to Aa1) on Friday 16 May, triggering a two-session equity drawdown before rapid absorption. NVDA Q1 FY2027 earnings (after close May 20) were the dominant catalyst: record revenue \$81.6B (+85% YoY), Data Center \$75.2B (+92%), \$80B buyback, dividend raised from \$0.01 to \$0.25 quarterly. US30 set a new year high of 50,830 intraday on May 22. NAS100 approached the 29,679 year high. GER40 staged a +3.77% four-session reversal. UK CPI April printed +2.8% YoY (softest since March 2025), advancing BoE pivot odds. GBPCAD counter-intuitively recovered as oil weakness pressured CAD. Gold tested 4,465 intraday before settling at 4,523 — the correction from the 5,602 ATH continues. PMI Flash on Friday May 23 is the next major multi-instrument catalyst.

GENERATED

2026-05-26 21:45:00 UTC

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LIVE MARKET DATA

INSTRUMENT	PRICE	DAY CHG %	DAY RANGE	52W RANGE	SIGNAL
US30	50,580	+0.58%	50,435 – 50,830	41,828 – 50,830	BULLISH
NAS100	29,482	+0.42%	29,424 – 29,664	21,033 – 29,679	BULLISH
GER40	24,889	+1.15%	24,676 – 24,944	21,864 – 25,508	NEU-BULL
AUDUSD	0.7159	+0.06%	0.7130 – 0.7169	0.6374 – 0.7277	NEU-BEAR
GBPCAD	1.8546	+0.23%	1.8546 – 1.8563	1.8018 – 1.8915	NEUTRAL
XAGUSD	76.20	-0.71%	75.26 – 77.42	32.66 – 121.30	NEU-BEAR
XAUUSD	4,523	-0.15%	4,488 – 4,547	3,242 – 5,586	BEARISH

SCORECARD VS PREVIOUS REPORT

INSTRUMENT	PREVIOUS BIAS	RESULT	VERDICT
US30	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	+2.13% to new year high 50,830 intraday; broke above 50,000 and 50,200 resistance	WRONG
NAS100	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	+1.22% to 29,482; NVDA blowout drove post-dip recovery toward year high 29,679	CORRECT
GER40	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	+3.77% to 24,889; four-session reversal broke above 24,226 and 24,492 resistance	WRONG
AUDUSD	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	-0.40% to 0.71296; broke below 0.7100 floor intraday May 20 (low 0.7088)	WRONG
GBPCAD	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	+1.05% to 1.85591; UK CPI soft (2.8%) confirmed thesis but oil pullback weakened CAD more	WRONG
XAGUSD	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	+0.15% essentially flat; dipped to 73.79 (May 19) then recovered to 76.20	PARTIALLY
XAUUSD	NEUTRAL	-0.49% to 4,523; modest decline consistent with neutral; May 20 low 4,465 held stop 4,460	CORRECT

TOP CONVICTION TRADES

#1 **NAS100** LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
29,200-29,350	30,200	29,000

NVDA Q1 FY2027 blowout confirmed AI capex supercycle: \$81.6B revenue +85% YoY, Data Center \$75.2B +92%, \$80B buyback, dividend raised 25x to \$0.25 quarterly. Year high 29,679 is within 0.7% — break above opens 30,200 measured-move discovery. Note: prior Sunday 17 May NAS100 LONG (entered ~28,700-28,800) should be held with trailing stop at 29,000. Risk-reward 1:3.4 at midpoint entry (29,275).

#2 **XAUUSD** SHORT

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
4,540-4,560	4,400	4,610

Broken support 4,600 confirmed as resistance (May 22 session high 4,547 respects zone). The 4,741 bullish trigger breach (May 12 high 4,765) proved a false breakout — gold reversed -6.2% from that intraday high. Moody's downgrade absorbed with no durable safe-haven bid. Iran ceasefire holds. Fed hold equals elevated real yields headwind. Close prior XAUUSD LONG (stop 4,460) and replace with this SHORT. Risk-reward 1:2.5.

#3 **GER40** LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
24,700-24,900	25,507	24,400

GER40 broke above both the 24,226 and 24,492 resistance levels (now confirmed as support). Year high 25,507 is 2.5% from current price. Global risk-on from NVDA and oil pullback supports Eurozone equity sentiment. CONDITIONAL on Eurozone PMI Flash (Fri May 23) printing above 49.5 — exit immediately if PMI misses below 49.0. Risk-reward 1:1.8 at midpoint entry (24,800). Lower conviction than Trades 1 and 2 given PMI event risk.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS • 1 OF 7

US30

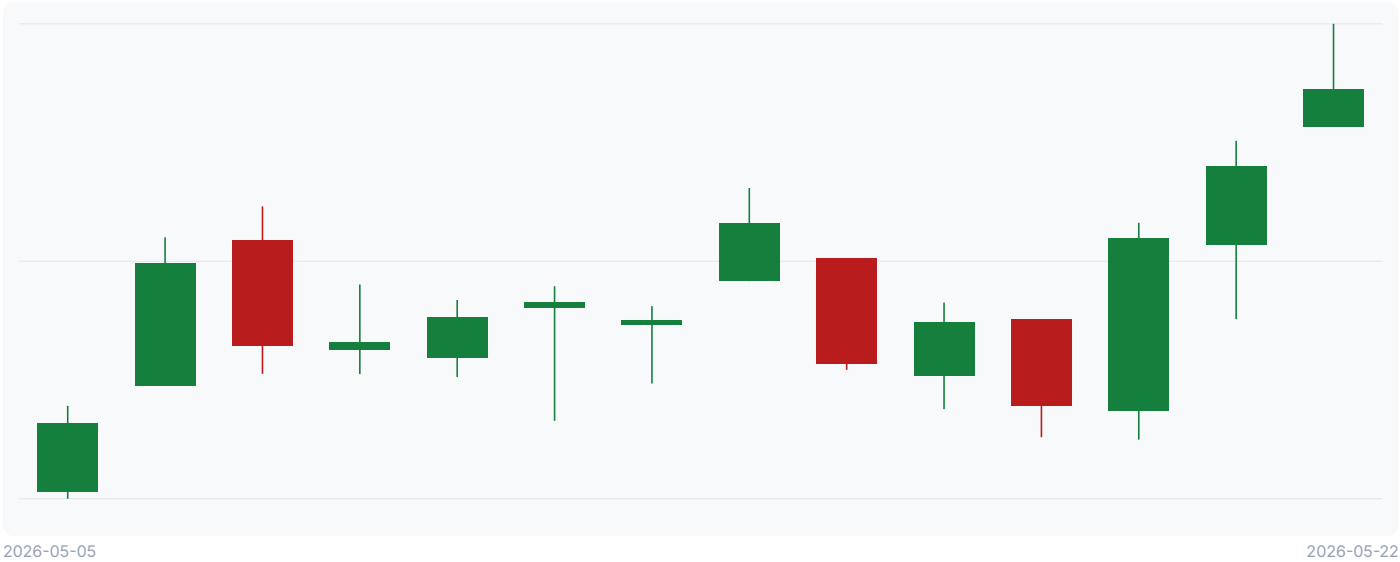
Dow Jones Industrial Average

50,580

+294 • +0.58%

BULLISH • +50

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
50,435 – 50,830	41,828 – 50,830	50,286	55%

SUPPORTS

	May 20 recovery close — first defensive layer	
S1		50,063
S2	May 21 intraday low	49,697
S3	May 19 close / Moody's panic low area	49,352

RESISTANCES

R1	New year high set intraday May 22	50,830
R2	Major psychological round number	51,000
R3	Measured-move projection from Apr base	51,500

ANALYSIS

Price action: Two-session Moody's drawdown (Mon low 49,353 / Tue low 49,245) absorbed by Wednesday oil-pullback rally (+645 pts session, close 50,009). Post-NVDA momentum extended to new year high 50,830 intraday May 22. 50,000 confirmed as support. Fundamentals: Moody's Aa1 absorbed; oil pullback reduces inflation tail; FOMC hold 3.50-3.75%; NVDA AI tailwind. Outlook: 3-5 day BULLISH. Buy dips 50,250-50,450 stop 49,950 target 51,500. Catalyst: PMI Flash Fri May 23, FOMC Minutes Tue May 27.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS • 2 OF 7

NAS100

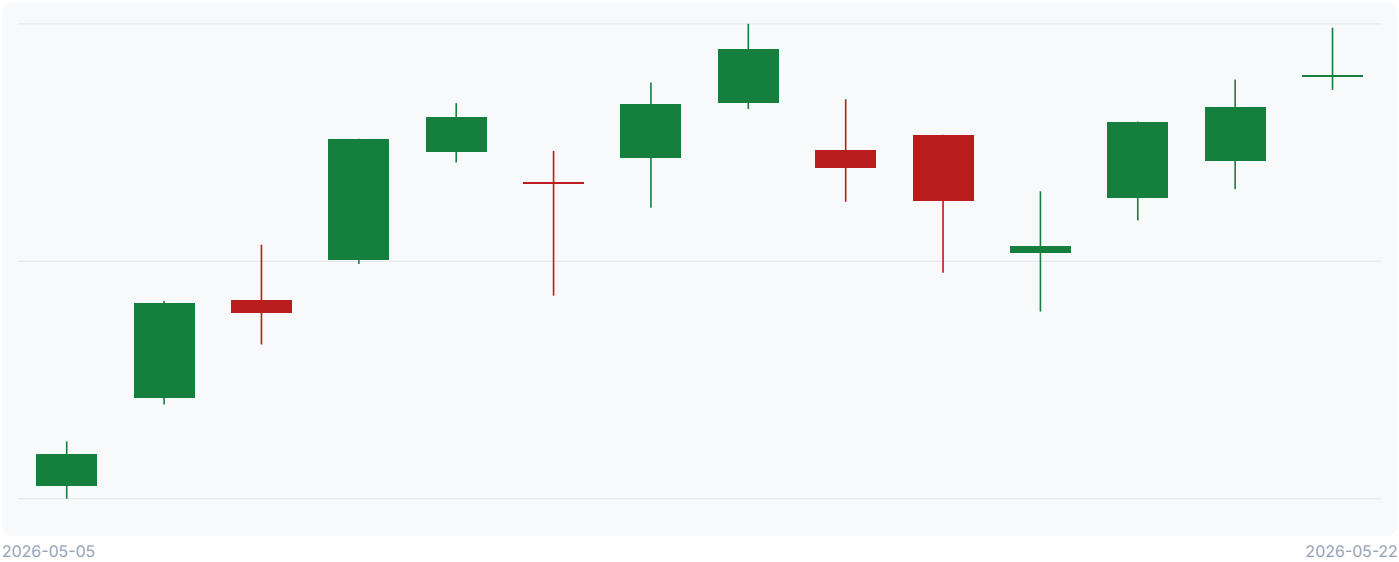
Nasdaq 100

29,482

+124 • +0.42%

BULLISH • +75

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

29,424 – 29,664

52-WEEK RANGE

21,033 – 29,679

PREVIOUS CLOSE

29,357

EVENT IMPACT

65%

SUPPORTS

- S1** May 20 close / NVDA pre-earnings base 29,297
- S2** May 21 intraday low 29,040
- May 18 Moody's dip low / structural buy
- S3** zone 28,717

RESISTANCES

- R1** May 22 session high 29,664
- R2** Year high — May 14 29,679
- R3** Measured-move projection above year high 30,200

ANALYSIS

Price action: Dipped to 28,567 May 19 (Moody's panic low), entering the 28,700-28,900 prior-report buy zone. Surged on NVDA catalyst (after close May 20): close 29,298 May 20, 29,357 May 21, 29,482 May 22. Year high 29,679 within 197 points. Fundamentals: NVDA Q1 FY27 \$81.6B +85% YoY; Data Center \$75.2B +92%; \$80B buyback; dividend 25x lift. AI capex confirmed. Outlook: 3-5 day BULLISH. Buy dips 29,200-29,350 stop 29,000 target 30,200. Catalyst: PMI Flash May 23.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS • 3 OF 7

GER40

DAX Performance Index

24,889

+282 • +1.15%

NEU•BULL • +35

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

24,676 – 24,944

52-WEEK RANGE

21,864 – 25,508

PREVIOUS CLOSE

24,607

EVENT IMPACT

75%

SUPPORTS

- S1** May 21 close / recent consolidation pivot **24,607**
- S2** May 11 consolidation — structural bid **24,350**
- S3** May 15 low / key structural support **23,918**

RESISTANCES

- R1** May 22 session high — immediate cap **24,944**
- R2** May 6 spike high — major near-term cap **25,153**
- R3** Year high / all-time high — ultimate target **25,507**

ANALYSIS

Price action: Hit 23,797 low May 18 (Moody's open) then staged the basket's most dramatic reversal — +4.6% in four sessions to 24,889. Broke above both 24,226 and 24,492 resistance (now confirmed support). Year high 25,507 within 2.5%. Fundamentals: Global risk-on from NVDA; oil pullback reduces energy margin squeeze; ECB June 11 live. Outlook: 3-5 day NEUTRAL-BULLISH conditional on Eurozone PMI Flash May 23 not printing below 49.0. Buy 24,700-24,900 stop 24,400 target 25,507. Exit immediately if PMI misses below 49.0.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS • 4 OF 7

AUDUSD

Australian Dollar vs US Dollar

0.7159

+0.0005 • +0.06%

NEU-BEAR • -30

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

0.7130 - 0.7169

52-WEEK RANGE

0.6374 - 0.7277

PREVIOUS CLOSE

0.7154

EVENT IMPACT

60%

SUPPORTS

- May 20 intraday low — critical near-term floor **0.7088**
- May 19 intraday low — extreme floor **0.7080**
- April structural base **0.7050**

RESISTANCES

- R1 May 20 session high / near-term cap **0.7171**
- R2 Prior week resistance **0.7219**
- R3 Year high — 2026 ceiling **0.7277**

ANALYSIS

Price action: Broke below 0.7100 intraday May 20 (low 0.7088) — first breach since April. Recovered to 0.7150 range May 21-22 but settled back to 0.71296. Failed to track global equity risk-on. Fundamentals: USD fiscal concern from Moody's suppressing AUD; RBA at 4.35% post-hike no further hike priced; China activity mixed. Outlook: 3-5 day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell rallies above 0.7150 stop 0.7185 target 0.7050. Reclaim of 0.7183 with conviction required to flip bias.

GBPCAD

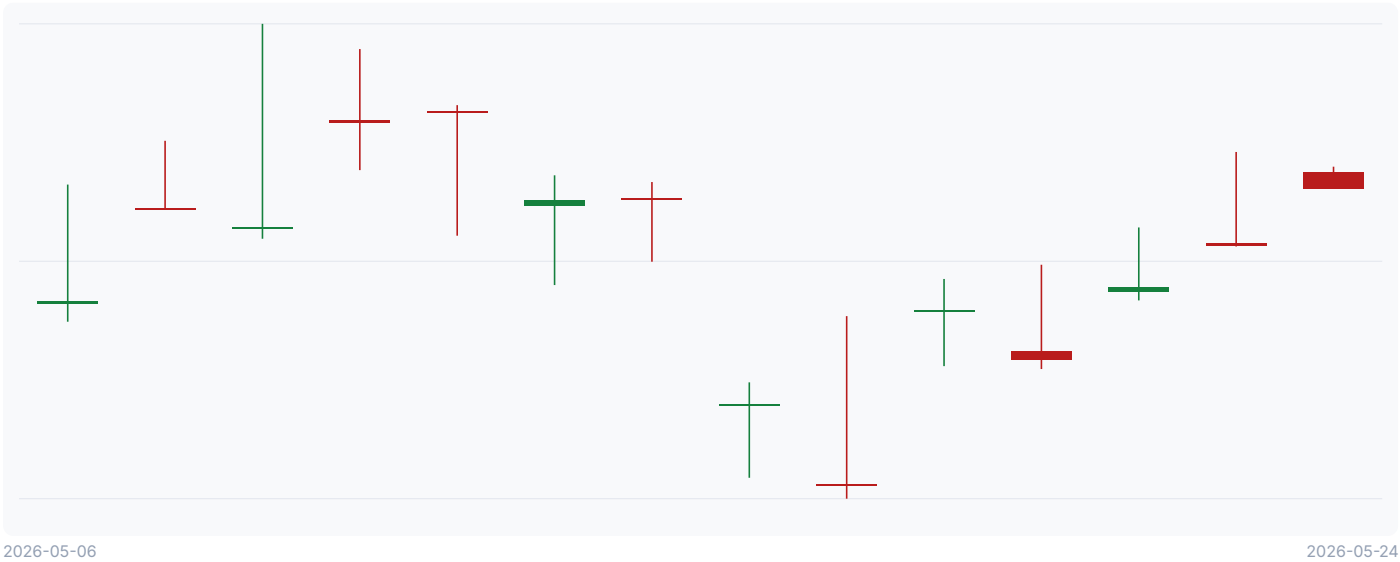
British Pound vs Canadian Dollar

1.8546

+0.0042 • +0.23%

NEUTRAL • +10

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
1.8546 – 1.8563	1.8018 – 1.8915	1.8503	55%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES			
S1	May 20 close	1.8411	R1	May 22 session high	1.8575
S2	May 18 low — key swing support	1.8302	R2	Prior resistance — broken support cluster	1.8611
S3	2026 lower structural bound	1.8200	R3	Year high	1.8915

ANALYSIS

Price action: Fell to 1.8302 May 18 (Moody's open) then reversed to 1.8559 current, driven primarily by CAD weakness on oil pullback. UK CPI April 2.8% (below 3.0% consensus) confirmed GBP-negative thesis but oil offset the pair move. Broken support 1.8430 has been recovered from above. Fundamentals: UK CPI 2.8% BoE pivot-positive; BoC June 4 next catalyst; oil direction primary driver. Outlook: 3-5 day NEUTRAL. Range trade 1.8430-1.8580. Catalyst: BoC Jun 4.

XAGUSD

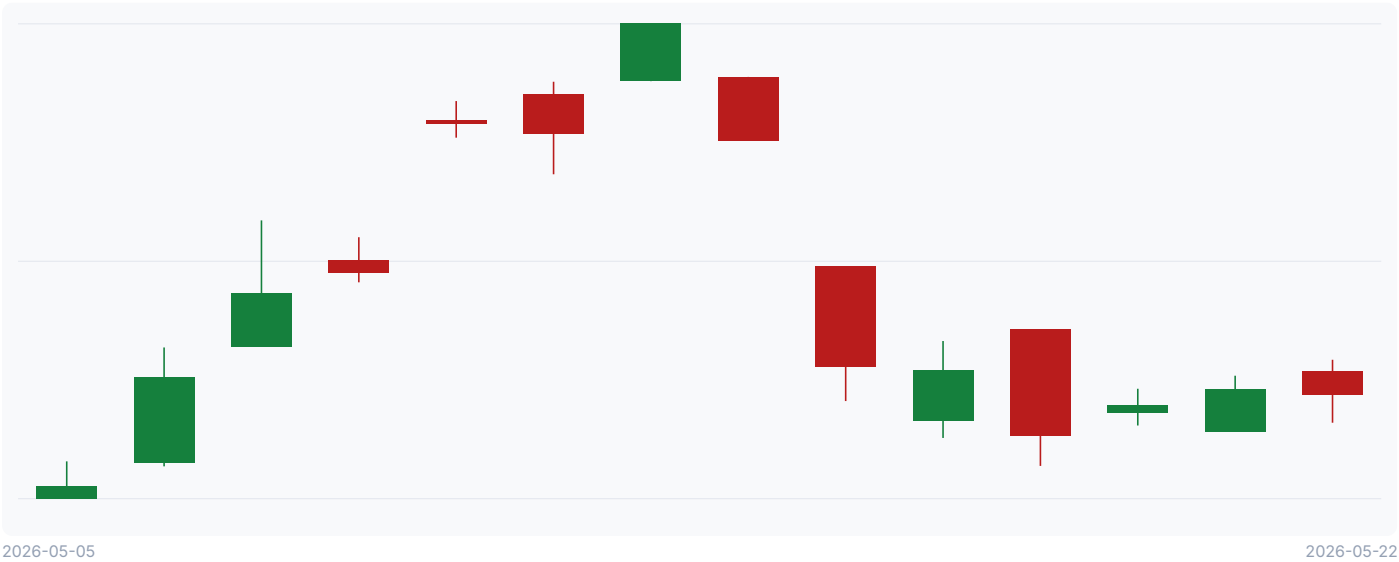
Silver Spot

76.20

-0.55 • -0.71%

NEU-BEAR • -45

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

75.26 – 77.42

52-WEEK RANGE

32.66 – 121.30

PREVIOUS CLOSE

76.75

EVENT IMPACT

50%

SUPPORTS

- S1** May 19 close **74.83**
May 19 intraday low — immediate structural
- S2** floor **73.79**
- S3** Deeper structural support **72.50**

RESISTANCES

- R1** May 18 session high **78.05**
- R2** May 15 close — primary near-term cap **80.61**
May 14 close — major cap above which trend changes
- R3** **84.91**

ANALYSIS

Price action: Crashed -17% from 88.89 peak (May 13) to 73.79 intraday low (May 19) on leveraged long liquidation. Stabilized at 74-77 range. Broken support 80.61 now confirmed resistance. Fundamentals: Tracks gold as primary driver; industrial demand (solar, semis) provides floor; gold/silver ratio approx 59:1 at current prices. Outlook: 3-5 day NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell rallies to 78.00-78.50 stop 79.50 target 73.79. No flip to BULLISH until 84.91 recovered on a session close.

XAUUSD

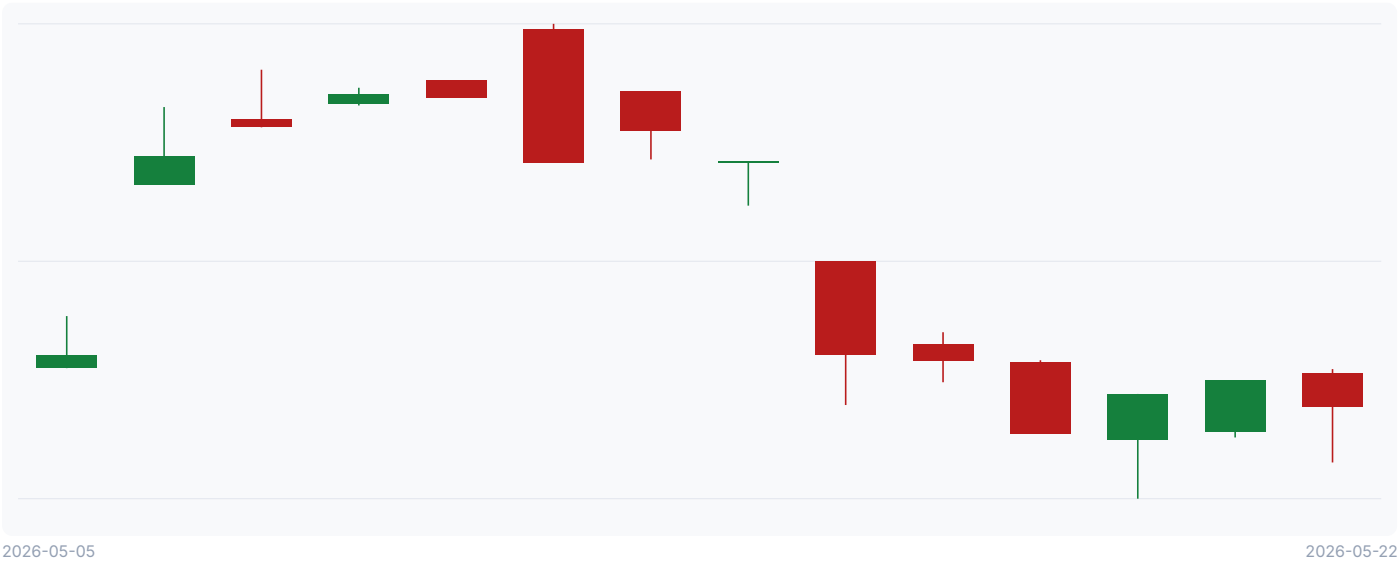
Gold Spot

4,523

-7 · -0.15%

BEARISH · -60

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
4,488 – 4,547	3,242 – 5,586	4,530	65%

SUPPORTS

S1

May 20 intraday low — critical near-term floor

4,465

S2

Round number / primary bear target

4,400

S3

Pre-Iran-war breakout structural base

4,350

RESISTANCES

R1

May 22 session high

4,547

Broken support zone now confirmed

R2

resistance

4,600

Bullish recovery trigger — no flip until

R3

confirmed close above

4,741

ANALYSIS

Price action: 4,741 bullish trigger breach (May 12 high 4,765) proved a false breakout — gold reversed -6.2% from that intraday high. Tested 4,465 intraday May 20 (5 pts above 4,460 stop from prior LONG trade). Recovery to 4,523-4,540 range. Broken support 4,600 confirmed resistance (session high 4,547 respects zone). Fundamentals: Iran ceasefire holds; Moody's provided no durable safe-haven bid; Fed hold = elevated real yields headwind; 4,741 false breakout confirmed. Outlook: 3-5 day BEARISH (flip from NEUTRAL). Close prior LONG (stop 4,460) and enter SHORT. Sell rallies 4,540-4,560 stop 4,610 target 4,400.

UPCOMING EVENTS

DATE	TIME	EVENT	IMPACT
2026-05-18	Market open	Moody's Aa1 downgrade reaction — risk-off open (US30 low 49,353; NAS100 low 28,717)	Very High
2026-05-20	06:00 GMT	UK CPI April (+2.8% YoY, below 3.0% consensus — BoE pivot odds advance)	High
2026-05-20	After close	NVIDIA Q1 FY2027 Earnings (\$81.6B revenue +85% YoY, Data Center \$75.2B — comprehensive beat)	Very High
2026-05-23	08:00 GMT	Eurozone PMI Flash May	High
2026-05-23	08:30 GMT	UK PMI Flash May (Composite)	High
2026-05-23	13:45 GMT	US PMI Flash May (Markit)	High
2026-05-27	18:00 GMT	FOMC Minutes (May 6-7 meeting)	High
2026-06-04	13:45 GMT	Bank of Canada Rate Decision	High
2026-06-05	12:30 GMT	US Non-Farm Payrolls May	Very High
2026-06-11	12:15 GMT	ECB Rate Decision (LIVE for hike)	Very High

RISK SCENARIOS

Eurozone PMI Flash Contraction below 49.0 — Fri May 23

30%

GER40 -2-3% reversal of four-session bounce; EUR negative; Trade 3 immediate exit. Validates ECB June 11 dovish hold over hike. Stagflation repricing for DAX.

NAS100 Extended Pullback on Weak PMI or Hawkish FOMC Tone

25%

NAS100 dips to 29,000-29,100 (Trade 1 stop zone). If 29,000 holds as support, treat as an add opportunity. If 29,000 broken on session close, reassess BULLISH bias.

Oil Price Reversal Higher above \$105 Brent

25%

CAD positive — GBPCAD loses the +1.05% recovery support and retraces toward 1.8411-1.8302. AUD mixed. Inflation re-priced higher puts pressure on equity forward multiples and partially reactivates gold safe-haven bid.

US 10-Year Yield Breaks and Holds Above 4.60% on Moody's Fiscal Repricing

20%

Gold -2-3% (real yield dominates safe-haven), equities -1-2%, USD positive. Accelerates Trade 2 XAUUSD SHORT. FOMC Minutes May 27 are the most likely trigger. NAS100 multiple compression risk.

ECB Pre-June-11 Hawkish Signal (35% ECB hike probability at June 11)

35%

EUR +1-2%, GER40 -2-3% on stagflation repricing (tighter ECB plus weak PMI simultaneously). Key risk to GER40 Trade 3. Most likely trigger: ECB speaker comments this week.